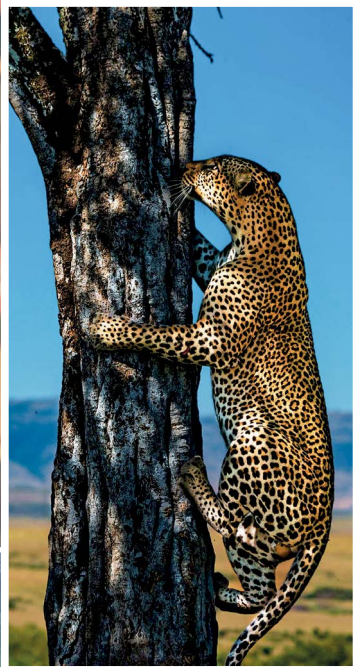




The stealthy grace of a wild leopard. Photo clicked by Jaju



Jaju (fifth from right) with his biker friends pose for a group photo Ladakh



Jaju exploring the rugged terrain of Ladakh

Khamoshiyan, Phir Kabhi, and Humdard, all originally sung by Arijit Singh. For him, these sessions were a remarkable experience in understanding the intricacies of studio recording.

But if you think that music is just a hobby, you wouldn't be more wrong. Jaju treats music as both therapy and spiritual calling. "The process, especially listening to my own recordings, offers an instant mood boost and a deep sense of personal satisfaction," he says.

He also believes that one's passions should never be contained in a box. It is not surprising, therefore, that when he is not consumed by corporate affairs, he finds reprieve in wildlife and street photography, apart from music. In fact, it is photography that has pulled Jaju away from his corner

office and into the dense forests of Bandhavgarh or Masai Mara, or even into the vast and melancholic cityscapes of New York and Tokyo.

"My lens captures fleeting moments, framing the untamed beauty of nature and the candid spontaneity of urban life," he says.

He ventured into photography in 2011, sparked by a birthday gift from his wife: a Canon 60D camera with an 18-135mm kit lens. "My first encounter with a tiger in Bandhavgarh's dense forests was a turning point. Since then, I've been captivated by the tranquillity of nature," he adds.

But how often can someone with a busy corporate life escape into the uncharted realms of their passions? For Jaju, no matter how busy the schedule, he still aims for at least two wildlife trips annually.

His approach is to travel during off-peak seasons and usually he chooses lesser-known destinations. His next adventure is a March expedition to Tanzania to observe silverback gorillas.

Coming from a tech background, Jaju is conscious of the fact that photography is a combination of both art and science. He has now undertaken numerous online courses, notably from award-winning photographer John Greengo. Jaju's wife is an artist, and in her he has found an able companion who understands how important art can be to one's life.

Jaju's photography arsenal now includes a Sony A9 mirrorless camera, complemented by a versatile mix of Sony and Sigma lenses. His primary lens for wildlife is the Sigma 150-600mm, and a Sony 70-200mm lens for varied shots. Additionally, he uses a Sony A6300 mirrorless camera and a Light L16. For more creative endeavours, he has a selection of prime lenses for portrait and street photography, a DJI Drone, a 360-degree action camera, along with an assortment of filters and polarisers. He has even mastered post-production skills, and this has not only allowed him to refine his photos but has also made them more vibrant.

"Juggling my professional responsibilities with my passion for photography and music has taught me valuable time management skills. It has also provided a creative outlet that complements my work-life balance," says Jaju as he signs off. **BT**

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